salesmsg

Financial Services SMS Compliance

Getting consent right

What carriers expect before you send a financial services text.

Why financial messaging gets extra scrutiny

Carriers watch closely. Financial services is one of the most closely watched categories in business texting. Carriers filter it harder than almost anything else, and a single word in one message can get a campaign suspended.

This guide covers what you can send from a 10DLC number, the language that triggers filtering, and the consent setup carriers expect — so your messages land and your account stays in good standing.

Get consent right

Every contact must have verifiable, specific consent on file before you send.

Opt-in method	Collect explicit, checkbox-based opt-in with fully compliant disclosure language.
Separate checkboxes	Each use case — transactional and informational — needs its own checkbox.
Privacy policy	State that mobile numbers, SMS consent and message data are never sold or shared.
Consent records	Store timestamped records for every contact and keep them for at least four years.

Need form wording and disclosure language?

Form wording, disclosure placement, and privacy-policy language are covered step by step in the SMS Opt-In Compliance Guide — ask your Salesmsg team for a copy.

salesmsg

Financial Services SMS Compliance

What to include, what to avoid

Required content in every message and practices that trigger carrier filtering.

What to put in every message

First-party only	Account updates, payment confirmations, appointment reminders and service notifications are safest.
Company name	Identify your company by name in every initial message you send.
Opt-out instructions	Include opt-out instructions in every initial message.
STOP instruction	Include "Reply STOP to unsubscribe" in every broadcast you send.

What to avoid

Any of these practices can get a campaign suspended.

No assumed opt-in	Contacts need verifiable proof: a web form, keyword opt-in or verbal consent.
No bundled consent	Each message type needs its own checkbox; bundling is noncompliant.
No data sharing	Any policy mentioning sharing or selling consumer data makes you noncompliant.
CTIA quiet hours	Never send before 8:00 AM or after 9:00 PM recipient local time.
Unregistered numbers	Carrier fines range from $1,000 to $10,000+ per violation.
Promotional on 10DLC	Loan or financial product promotions require an approved short code.

URL shorteners must be branded

Public shorteners like bit.ly or tinyurl are prohibited. Use company-branded short links only.

salesmsg

Financial Services SMS Compliance

Language that gets filtered

Terms flagged by carriers and Twilio as high-risk financial content.

Any message that solicits, arranges, brokers, refers, refinances or markets new loans is prohibited by mobile carriers. Using flagged terms can trigger filtering, campaign suspension or fines of $1,000–$10,000+ per violation.

High-risk terms by category

Category	Status	Examples
Loans & lending	**Prohibited**	"payday loan", "fast cash", "pre-approved loan", "guaranteed approval"
Debt — all senders	**Prohibited**	"debt consolidation", "credit repair", "debt relief", "collection"
Investment & crypto	**Prohibited**	"invest now", "guaranteed returns", "cryptocurrency", "forex"
Get rich quick	**Prohibited**	"make money fast", "financial freedom", "guaranteed income"
Deceptive claims	**Prohibited**	"guaranteed funding", "100% approval rate", "free money"
Lead generation	**Prohibited**	"based on your profile", "on behalf of", "affiliate offer"

Search your saved content first

Flagged terms appear in templates, automations, broadcasts and signature lines you set up months ago. Search your saved content before you scale up sending.

salesmsg

Financial Services SMS Compliance

What you can send on 10DLC

Permitted 10DLC message types for first-party financial services.

Permitted message types

Message type	Example
Account notifications	Your payment of $500 was received. — ABC Financial
Appointment reminders	Your consultation with ABC Advisors is tomorrow at 2 PM.
Transaction confirmations	Your wire transfer of $1,200 has been processed. Ref #12345.
Service updates	ABC Financial: system maintenance Saturday 2–4 AM EST.
Two-factor authentication	Your verification code is 482910. Do not share this code.

Before you send

Run through this checklist before every campaign launch.

Consent on file	Separate checkbox per message type; timestamped records retained four years.
Privacy policy	Confirms data is not sold or shared with third parties.
Message content	Company name and opt-out in every initial message; no flagged wording.
Sending window	Scheduled 8:00 AM–9:00 PM recipient local time.

Not sure a message will pass?

Send it to your Salesmsg team first. We'd rather review it now than untangle a filtered campaign later.